

The Model Did It

Flyxion

September 2026

When the system performs well, the language reaches immediately for a mind. It understood the question. It reasoned through the problem. It showed creativity, judgment, even a kind of taste. The demo is narrated the way a proud teacher narrates a gifted student, and the company's name appears mainly as the setting in which this emergent intelligence happened to arise, a garden that grew something remarkable rather than a factory that manufactured it on a deadline.

When the system causes harm, the language changes registers entirely, and the change is instructive because of how completely it reverses the first framing. Now the system is unpredictable, the way weather is unpredictable. It hallucinated. It exhibited an emergent behavior nobody anticipated, as though it were a geological process rather than a shipped product with a named engineering team, a training budget, and a release date approved by people who could have delayed it. The very intelligence that was, one press cycle earlier, evidence of the company's achievement is now evidence of the system's autonomy from the company, a natural phenomenon that simply happened to the world, the way a storm happens to a coastline no one built.

Both framings cannot be true, and the tell is that no one is ever asked to reconcile them, because they are never deployed in the same sentence to the same audience. A mind sophisticated enough to reason and show judgment is a mind whose outputs its maker is responsible for shaping, the way a publisher is responsible for what it prints even when the prose reads as though it wrote itself. A system genuinely too unpredictable to have foreseen its harmful outputs is a system too unpredictable to have been credited, an essay earlier, with the judgment being celebrated. The personification is not a confused metaphor stumbled into by people unused to describing software. It is asymmetric on purpose, deployed for credit and withdrawn for liability, and the withdrawal always arrives at precisely the moment the sentence would otherwise have had to end with the name of a person who signed off on the release.